

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

What 3 words describe Europe in 1200?

What was feudalism?

How did the Catholic Church hold Europe together?

AP EXAM TIP

Europe in 1200 was the **LEAST** powerful major civilization in AP World History. It had no commercial revolution (unlike Song China), no unified state, and far less scientific knowledge than the Islamic world. This is important context for understanding its later rise.

CCOT theme:

What changed in Europe between 1200 and 1450?

COMMON MISTAKE

Do **NOT** project European power backward. In 1200, Chinese, Islamic, and African civilizations were more commercially advanced. European global dominance came **LATER** (Unit 3, post-1450). Unit 1 Europe = weak, fragmented, catching up.

What role did the Crusades play in European development?

EUROPE IN 1200 — THREE KEY CHARACTERISTICS

- › **Feudal:** Political power was decentralized — kings were weak; lords controlled land and raised armies; serfs worked the land in exchange for protection. No unified states.
- › **Fragmented:** No pan-European political unit; multiple kingdoms, city-states, and the Holy Roman Empire (which was neither holy, nor Roman, nor an empire in any unified sense)
- › **Catholic:** The Catholic Church was the ONE institution that cut across political boundaries; Latin was the shared language of scholarship; the Pope claimed authority over all Christian rulers

THE CHURCH AS UNIFYING FORCE

- › Catholic Church owned ~30% of European land by 1200
- › Pope claimed authority to crown (and depose) kings — e.g., Investiture Controversy (Pope vs. Holy Roman Emperor over who appointed bishops)
- › Excommunication (expulsion from the Church) = political weapon; rulers could lose legitimacy
- › Universities (Bologna, Paris, Oxford) were Church-sponsored; Latin education
- › Crusades organized by the Pope — demonstrated Church's ability to mobilize Christian Europe

EUROPE'S POSITION IN 1200 COMPARED TO WORLD

- › **Compared to Song China:** No commercial revolution, no paper money, no civil service exam — far less economically sophisticated
- › **Compared to Islamic world:** Far less scientific/mathematical knowledge; much of what Europe knew of Aristotle came via Arabic translations
- › **Compared to Mali:** Mansa Musa's gold caused inflation in Cairo — European economies were significantly smaller
- › **BUT:** Europe was beginning its 'take-off' — Crusades opened trade with the Islamic world; Italian city-states (Venice, Genoa) were becoming commercial powers

THE ARC OF CH. 6 (1200–1450)

Europe begins this period feudal and fragmented; ends it significantly changed by: the Black Death (which killed 1/3 of the population), the Hundred Years' War (which forged English and French national identity), the Western Schism (which weakened papal authority), and a commercial revival driven by Italian city-states and the Hanseatic League.

AP TIP: Europe's weakness in Unit 1 is the **SETUP** for its later dominance in Unit 2. Understanding why Europe was behind in 1200 helps explain why the changes of 1200–1450 were transformative.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Europe in 1200 = **feudal** (decentralized power), **fragmented** (no unified states), **Catholic** (Church as the one unifying institution). Europe was the least commercially/scientifically advanced major civilization — behind China, the Islamic world, and even West Africa in commercial sophistication. By 1450: Black Death, Hundred Years' War, and Western Schism had transformed the continent and set the stage for European expansion in Unit 2.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Define feudalism. What were its 3 key relationships?

Define manorialism. How did it differ from feudalism?

Serfdom:

How did serfs differ from enslaved people?

AP EXAM TIP

Feudalism comparison = top AP prompt. Always compare European feudalism to Japanese feudalism (both had warrior elites, land-for-loyalty contracts, weak central authority). Note similarities AND differences (Confucianism vs. Catholicism; emperor vs. pope).

Why did feudalism decline in Europe after 1300?

COMMON MISTAKE

Feudalism was NOT simply 'lords and serfs.' It was a layered system of mutual obligations — the king granted land to lords, lords to knights, knights protected peasants. Each level had both rights AND duties.

Three-field system:

What was it? Why did it matter?

FEUDALISM — Political and Military Structure

- › **Definition:** A system of political and military organization based on land grants in exchange for loyalty and military service
- › **King → Lords (Nobles):** King granted fiefs (land) to lords in exchange for military service and loyalty
- › **Lords → Knights:** Lords granted smaller fiefs to knights in exchange for mounted military service
- › **Lords → Serfs (Peasants):** Lords provided protection; serfs provided labor and a share of crops
- › Obligations were MUTUAL — not simply domination; lords owed protection; serfs owed labor

MANORIALISM — Economic Structure

- › The economic dimension of feudalism — the manor (lord's estate) was the basic economic unit
- › Serfs farmed the lord's land (demesne) and their own strips in open fields
- › **Serfdom:** Serfs were NOT enslaved — they could not be sold separately from the land; they had customary rights (use of commons, village courts); but they could not leave the land without the lord's permission
- › Manor was largely self-sufficient: mill, forge, bakehouse, church all on the estate

THREE-FIELD SYSTEM — Agricultural Innovation

- › Divided farmland into three strips: winter crop (wheat/rye) | spring crop (oats/barley) | fallow (resting)
- › Rotation each year — improved yields by 30–50% vs. two-field system
- › Fed population growth; gave some peasants surplus to sell at market
- › Combined with heavy plow and horse collar (allowing horse-powered plowing) = European agricultural revolution c. 900–1200

DECLINE OF FEUDALISM — Multiple Causes

- › **Black Death (1347–1351):** Killed 1/3 of European population; massive labor shortage → surviving serfs could demand higher wages or leave manors → weakened lords' control
- › **Peasant revolts:** French Jacquerie (1358), English Peasants' Revolt (1381) — serfs demanded rights; signs of destabilizing feudal order
- › **Commercial revival:** Growing towns and markets allowed serfs to flee to cities ('city air makes you free')
- › **Centralized monarchies:** Kings began bypassing feudal lords to create direct taxation and professional armies
- › **Hundred Years' War:** Showed professional armies (English longbows) defeating feudal knights — undermined the military basis of the knight class

AP TIP: European feudalism vs. Japanese feudalism is the top comparison. Both: warriors (knights/samurai), land-for-loyalty, weak central ruler, strong local lords. Difference: European had Catholic Church as a third power; Japan had shogun as de facto ruler with emperor as figurehead.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Feudalism = layered system of land-for-loyalty; mutual obligations from king to serf. **Manorialism** = the economic side; serfs farmed manor land in exchange for protection. **Three-field system** boosted agricultural yields. Feudalism declined due to: **Black Death** (labor shortage empowered serfs), peasant revolts, commercial revival, and rising centralized monarchies. Compare to Japanese feudalism: structural similarities, different religious/political context.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

What was the Pope's claim to authority?

Investiture Controversy

What was it? Who won? What does it reveal?

The Crusades:

Dates? Goals? Outcomes?

AP EXAM TIP

Crusades for AP = their **CONSEQUENCES** matter more than military outcomes. They opened European trade with Islamic world, transmitted Islamic learning (Aristotle's works) to Europe, and demonstrated both the Church's power AND its eventual failure to sustain European unity.

Mendicant orders:

What were they? (Franciscan, Dominican) Why significant?

COMMON MISTAKE

The Crusades were **NOT** uniformly Christian vs. Muslim. There were also Crusades against European heretics (Albigensian Crusade) and political rivals. And the Fourth Crusade (1204) sacked **CHRISTIAN** Constantinople rather than fighting Muslims.

Western Schism (1378–1417):

What happened? What was its impact?

THE CATHOLIC CHURCH'S AUTHORITY STRUCTURE

- › **Pope:** Claimed to be Christ's representative on earth (Vicar of Christ); authority over all Christian souls AND rulers
- › **Bishops and Archbishops:** Administered church provinces; appointed by Pope (contested by kings)
- › **Parish priests:** Administered sacraments (baptism, marriage, last rites) — controlled access to salvation
- › **Excommunication:** Expelled from Church = could not receive sacraments = political weapon against kings
- › **Interdict:** Entire kingdom denied Church services — powerful pressure on rulers

INVESTITURE CONTROVERSY (1076–1122)

- › Central question: Who appoints bishops — the Pope or the king?
- › **Pope Gregory VII** excommunicated Holy Roman Emperor Henry IV (1076) over the issue
- › Henry IV walked to Canossa in the snow to beg forgiveness from the Pope — dramatic demonstration of papal authority
- › **Concordat of Worms (1122):** Compromise — Pope appoints bishops spiritually; kings invest them with land
- › **AP significance:** Shows the tension between religious and political authority in medieval Europe — church and state were NOT separate

THE CRUSADES (1095–c.1291)

- › **First Crusade (1095–1099):** Called by Pope Urban II; captured Jerusalem briefly
- › Subsequent crusades largely failed to hold the Holy Land
- › **Fourth Crusade (1204):** Infamously sacked Christian Constantinople instead of fighting Muslims — weakened Byzantine Empire
- › **Military consequences:** Crusaders ultimately failed; Jerusalem lost permanently by 1291
- › **Economic consequences:** Opened European trade with the Islamic world; Italian city-states (Venice, Genoa) grew rich as suppliers
- › **Intellectual consequences:** Crusaders encountered Arabic translations of Aristotle; Islamic science and philosophy transmitted to Europe → foundations of Scholasticism

MENDICANT ORDERS — Church Reform from Within

- › **Franciscans** (founded by Francis of Assisi, 1209): Vow of poverty; preached to urban poor; challenged Church wealth
- › **Dominicans** (founded 1215): Emphasized education and preaching; ran the Inquisition; produced Thomas Aquinas
- › Both orders show the Church responding to criticism through internal reform — rather than breaking apart

WESTERN SCHISM (1378–1417) — Church's Crisis

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Catholic Church = Europe's most powerful institution; Pope claimed authority over all Christian rulers. **Investiture Controversy** (Pope vs. Emperor) showed church-state tension. **Crusades** failed militarily but succeeded economically (Italian trade revival) and intellectually (Arabic learning transmitted to Europe). **Mendicant orders** (Franciscan, Dominican) reformed the Church from within. **Western Schism** (two popes) severely damaged papal authority — prefiguring the Reformation.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
Where did the Black Death originate? How did it reach Europe? Trace the route. What % of Europe's population died? AP EXAM TIP The Black Death connects Ch. 1 (Mongol trade routes) to Ch. 2 (Islamic world devastated) to Ch. 6 (Europe transformed). It is the single event that best demonstrates how the Pax Mongolica's trade networks had NEGATIVE as well as positive consequences. Name 3 social consequences of the Black Death in Europe. Name 2 economic consequences of the Black Death in Europe. COMMON MISTAKE The Black Death did NOT only affect Europe. It devastated the Islamic world (Cairo, Baghdad), Central Asia, and China (contributing to the Yuan Dynasty's collapse). Always frame it as a EURASIAN event when using it in cross-regional essays.	ORIGINS AND SPREAD — The Route from Central Asia to Europe › Origin: Central Asian steppe (likely modern Kyrgyzstan/China border) — rodent-borne bubonic plague (<i>Yersinia pestis</i> bacterium) › 1330s–1340s: Spread through Mongol trade networks across Central Asia; devastated Yuan China › 1346: Reached Caffa (Crimea, Black Sea) — Mongols reportedly catapulted plague-infected corpses over the walls › 1347: Genoese ships from Caffa brought plague to Sicily; spread rapidly through Mediterranean ports › 1348–1350: Swept through Western Europe via trade routes; reached England and Scandinavia by 1349 › Mechanism: Spread by fleas on rats, then person-to-person via respiratory droplets (pneumonic form) DEMOGRAPHIC IMPACT › Europe lost approximately 1/3 of its population (c. 25 million dead out of ~75 million) in the initial outbreak › Some regions lost 50–60% of their population › Population did not recover to pre-plague levels until c. 1500 in many areas › Islamic world: Cairo lost ~40% of population; Baghdad similarly devastated › China: Yuan Dynasty weakened by plague deaths + famine → accelerated collapse SOCIAL CONSEQUENCES IN EUROPE › Labor shortage: So many serfs died that lords could not find workers → surviving serfs could demand higher wages, better conditions, or freedom › Peasant revolts: French Jacquerie (1358), English Peasants' Revolt (1381) — serfs demanded end to feudal obligations while lords tried to reimpose old restrictions › Jewish persecution: Jews blamed for poisoning wells; pogroms (violent massacres) across Europe — example of scapegoating during crisis › Religious crisis: Why did God allow this? Flagellant movements (self-whipping as penance); some turned away from the Church › Cultural shift: 'Danse macabre' (Dance of Death) imagery — death as equalizer of rich and poor ECONOMIC CONSEQUENCES › Labor became more expensive: Landowners had to pay higher wages or lose workers to better offers › Serfdom weakened in Western Europe: Serfs gained bargaining power; many bought their freedom or fled to cities › Wages rose: Good for surviving workers; bad for landowners › Trade disrupted: But Italian city-states eventually rebuilt — commerce recovered faster than agriculture
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Black Death (1347–1351) = Central Asian bubonic plague spread along **Mongol trade routes** to Europe, killing ~1/3 of Europe's population. Social consequences: **labor shortage empowered serfs**, peasant revolts (Jacquerie, 1381), Jewish persecution, religious crisis. Economic: serfdom weakened in Western Europe as workers gained bargaining power. Cross-regional: also devastated the Islamic world and contributed to the Yuan Dynasty's collapse — frame as a **Eurasian event** in essays.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Magna Carta (1215):

What was it? Who signed it? What principles did it establish?

Parliament:

What was it? How did it develop in England?

Hundred Years' War (1337–1453):

Who fought? Why? What were the outcomes?

AP EXAM TIP

Magna Carta and Parliament are AP evidence for the emergence of **LIMITED GOVERNMENT** in Europe. They show that even medieval kings had to negotiate with powerful subjects — a distinctly European political development that will matter enormously in Units 4–6.

Joan of Arc:

Who? What did she do? Why significant for AP?

COMMON MISTAKE

Magna Carta did **NOT** establish democracy. It primarily protected the rights of nobles against the king. Its later importance as a precedent for constitutional government was a much later development, read backward into 1215.

MAGNA CARTA (1215) — Limiting Royal Power

- › King John of England forced to sign the Magna Carta ('Great Charter') by rebellious barons
- › Key provisions: no taxation without consent; no arbitrary imprisonment; right to a jury of peers
- › Originally protected NOBLES, not commoners — but later became a foundation for English constitutional tradition
- › **AP significance:** First major document limiting a European monarch's power; precedent for the idea that rulers are subject to law, not above it

PARLIAMENT — Representative Governance

- › Emerged in England c. 1265 (Simon de Montfort's Parliament); formalized under Edward I (1295)
- › Two chambers: **House of Lords** (nobles, bishops) + **House of Commons** (knights, merchants)
- › Power of the purse: Parliament had to approve new taxes — gave it leverage over the king
- › **AP significance:** Early example of representative institution checking royal power; contrast with Chinese imperial system (no representative bodies) or Islamic caliphate

HUNDRED YEARS' WAR (1337–1453)

- › Fought between England and France over the French throne (and English lands in France)
- › **English advantages early:** Longbow (Crecy 1346, Agincourt 1415) devastated French feudal knights — showed that medieval chivalric warfare was obsolete
- › **Joan of Arc (c.1412–1431):** French peasant girl who claimed divine visions; led French armies to victory at Orleans (1429); captured by English, burned at the stake, later canonized
- › **Outcome:** France expelled England from nearly all French territory; English retain only Calais by 1453
- › **AP significance:** Forged English and French national identities; demonstrated that professional armies could defeat feudal knights; undermined chivalric feudal warfare

CENTRALIZED MONARCHIES EMERGING FROM THE WARS

- › Both England and France emerged from the Hundred Years' War with **stronger centralized monarchies**
- › Kings used war financing to bypass feudal lords and tax commoners directly
- › Professional armies replaced feudal levies — kings no longer dependent on lords for military force
- › This centralization = the foundation for the European nation-states that will drive exploration in Unit 2

HANSEATIC LEAGUE — Commercial Power

A confederation of northern European merchant cities (Hamburg, Lubeck, Bruges) that dominated Baltic and North Sea trade. Shows that commercial power could rival political power in late medieval Europe. Precursor to the commercial capitalism that will fund European exploration.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Magna Carta (1215) = first document limiting English royal power; protected noble rights; precedent for constitutional government.

Parliament = representative body with power to approve taxes; checks royal authority. **Hundred Years' War (1337–1453)** forged English and French national identities; longbow ended feudal cavalry dominance; **Joan of Arc** turned the war for France. Outcome: stronger centralized monarchies — the foundation for European state-building in Unit 2.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Scholasticism:

What was it? What was its goal?

Thomas Aquinas

Who? What did he argue? Why is he AP-significant?

Universities:

*When/where did they emerge?
What did they teach?*

AP EXAM TIP

Scholasticism represents Europe **CATCHING UP** to Islamic scholarship. Much of Aristotle's work reached Europe through Arabic translations — via Crusader contact and Iberian translation centers. This East-to-West knowledge transfer is key for AP.

Vernacular literature:

What is it? Give 2 examples. Why does it matter?

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not say Europe had 'no culture' before the Renaissance. The medieval period produced Gothic cathedrals, university systems, vernacular literature, and the Scholastic synthesis — all sophisticated intellectual achievements.

Byzantine Empire:

What role did it play in preserving classical knowledge?

SCHOLASTICISM — Reconciling Faith and Reason

- › Dominant European intellectual tradition c. 1050–1400
- › Goal: reconcile **Christian theology** with **classical Greek philosophy** (especially Aristotle)
- › Method: systematic logical argument; question → objection → reply (dialectical method)
- › Key question: Can human reason support religious faith? Does faith require the abandonment of reason?
- › Answer (Aquinas): Yes — reason and faith are complementary, not contradictory

THOMAS AQUINAS (1225–1274) — Scholasticism's Master

- › Dominican friar; professor at University of Paris
- › **Summa Theologica**: Monumental synthesis of Aristotelian philosophy and Christian theology
- › Argued that God's existence could be proven through reason (Five Ways/Proofs)
- › Demonstrated that Aristotle's logic was compatible with — not opposed to — Christian doctrine
- › **AP significance**: Aquinas represents Europe absorbing and adapting Islamic-transmitted classical knowledge; intellectual counterpart to European commercial revival

UNIVERSITIES — Institutional Knowledge

- › First European universities: **Bologna** (law, c. 1088), **Paris** (theology, c. 1150), **Oxford** (c. 1167)
- › Church-sponsored but increasingly autonomous; attracted students from across Europe
- › Curriculum: **Trivium** (grammar, rhetoric, logic) + **Quadrivium** (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) + theology/law/medicine
- › **AP comparison**: European universities vs. Islamic madrasas — both created educated administrative/religious elites; madrasas focused on Islamic law/theology; universities added Greek philosophy and natural science

VERNACULAR LITERATURE — Culture for the People

- › Writing in local spoken languages (French, Italian, English) rather than Latin — accessible beyond clergy
- › **Dante's Divine Comedy** (Italian, c. 1320): Vernacular masterwork; reflects medieval cosmology
- › **Chaucer's Canterbury Tales** (English, c. 1390): Social satire of all English classes, including corrupt clergy
- › **AP significance**: Vernacular literature reflects growing literacy beyond clergy; cultural expression of a more commercially active, urbanizing society

BYZANTINE EMPIRE — Preserving Classical Knowledge

The Byzantine Empire (Eastern Roman Empire, survived until 1453) preserved Greek classical texts in Constantinople. When the Ottomans conquered Constantinople (1453), Greek scholars fled to Western Europe carrying manuscripts — contributing to the **Renaissance** (Unit 2). This is a key connection: Byzantine fall → Renaissance begins.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Scholasticism = medieval Europe's intellectual tradition; reconciled Christian faith with Aristotelian reason. **Thomas Aquinas** (Summa Theologica) = its greatest achievement. **Universities** (Bologna, Paris, Oxford) created educated elites. **Vernacular literature** (Dante, Chaucer) = culture beyond the clergy. Key AP connection: Europe's intellectual revival depended on Arabic-transmitted Greek knowledge + Byzantine scholars after 1453 — setting up the Renaissance in Unit 2.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
CCOT Framework: 3 continuities and 3 changes for Ch. 6 Top 3 AP essay prompts for Ch. 6: Key comparisons for Ch. 6 essays: AP EXAM TIP The Black Death is Ch. 6's most AP-exam-tested topic. Know: Central Asian origin → Mongol trade routes → Europe → 1/3 population dies → labor shortage → feudalism weakens. This chain is the core narrative. COMMON MISTAKES (1) Saying Europe was 'the most advanced' in 1200 — it wasn't. (2) Saying Magna Carta established democracy. (3) Forgetting the Black Death affected Asia AND Europe. (4) Saying the Crusades were a success. Terms to define in essays:	CCOT FRAMEWORK FOR CHAPTER 6 › CONTINUITIES: Catholic Church as dominant institution throughout (despite challenges) Feudal social structure persisting into 1400s Latin as language of scholarship Agricultural economy as foundation › CHANGES: Black Death kills 1/3 of population (1347–1351); labor shortage weakens serfdom Hundred Years' War forges national identities; rising centralized monarchies Western Schism (1378–1417) damages papal authority Commercial revival: Italian city-states, Hanseatic League › COMPLEXITY: Black Death paradoxically accelerated positive changes for peasants (labor shortage = more bargaining power) even as it caused immense suffering TOP AP ESSAY PROMPTS › 1. LEQ: 'Analyze continuity and change in European political systems 1200–1450.' → Use CCOT: feudalism weakening, Church challenges, Magna Carta/Parliament, rising monarchies › 2. SAQ: 'Explain ONE cause and ONE effect of the Black Death on European society.' → Cause: Mongol trade routes transmitted plague; Effect: labor shortage weakened feudalism / peasant revolts › 3. DBQ: 'Evaluate the extent to which the Black Death transformed Europe 1347–1450.' → Transformation: labor market, feudal decline, religious doubt; Continuity: Church survived, agriculture remained, social hierarchy persisted KEY AP-READY COMPARISONS › European feudalism vs. Japanese feudalism: Both: warriors (knights/samurai), land-for-loyalty, weak central ruler. Different: Catholic Church vs. Buddhist/Shinto; Pope vs. no equivalent in Japan; shogun as real ruler vs. multiple European kings › Catholic Church vs. Islamic ulama: Both maintained cultural continuity across political disruption; Church claimed political authority (Pope over kings); ulama had religious but not direct political authority › Black Death in Europe vs. Black Death in the Islamic world: Both devastated; Islamic world lost Baghdad's commercial role; Europe's feudal structure weakened › Magna Carta vs. no equivalent in China: Shows European rulers constrained by noble/legal tradition; Chinese emperors had no equivalent institutional check KEY TERMS TO DEFINE Feudalism Manorialism Serfdom Three-field system Catholic Church Pope Excommunication Investiture Controversy Crusades Scholasticism Thomas Aquinas University Vernacular Magna Carta Parliament Hundred Years' War Joan of Arc Black Death Western Schism Hanseatic League AP TIP: Connect Ch. 6 forward to Unit 2 in two ways: (1) Black Death's labor shortage and commercial revival → European prosperity → funding for exploration; (2) Byzantine fall (1453) → Greek scholars to Italy → Renaissance humanist learning → intellectual confidence for exploration. Both chains are complexity points.
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Ch. 6 AP mastery: (1) **Black Death** = Central Asian plague via Mongol routes; killed 1/3 of Europe; weakened feudalism via labor shortage; (2) **Magna Carta + Parliament** = European constitutionalism (compare: no equivalent in China or Islamic world); (3) **Hundred Years' War** = national identity + end of feudal warfare; (4) **Scholasticism** = Europe absorbing Islamic-transmitted Greek knowledge. All roads lead to Unit 2: Black Death + commercial revival + centralized monarchies = Europe ready to explore.